Slavery

Slavery was introduced in America when African slaves were brought to Jamestown, Virginia in 1619. The main aim of acquiring slaves was to have cheap labor to facilitate crop production. In only a few years, African slaves could be found all over USA as slavery became rampant. The invention of the cotton gin further increased the need for laborers as the slaves helped to build a new economic foundation for America.

Slavery began in America while the British were still in control and it continued after the American Revolution. Slavery was initially a way of replacing expensive labor with a cheaper form of work. Black slaves at that time worked in tobacco, rice and indigo production. Slavery soon became a necessity in America and it tempted every person who owned a small piece of land to hire slaves and get them to work on the farm at cheap costs. Slavery did face some opposition from the government but it was mostly the northern states that raised their voice against the practice. It did not sway the southern states who continued to exploit slaves. The south's economy soon became dependent on slaves to such an extent that they were willing to fight a civil war if they could continue the practice.

Many viewed slavery as a similar form of oppression that the Americans faced when the British forced their laws upon the early settlers. The American Revolution did not change laws as many people thought it would. The constitution did not provide equal rights to African Americans who were considered to be lower in status than Caucasian people.

It is well known that slavery was a brutal practice. Many supported the abolition movement that was aimed at removing all forms of slavery from the Constitution. The abolition movement rose to prominence and was led by many free black men such as Fredrick Douglass and others. There were of course also white supporters of the abolition movement. The media extensively covered the topic of slavery and many editorials spoke about slavery as a sin. There were others who believed slavery was ineffective in